

POS Mobile — User Manual

How to set up the app on a phone or tablet and use every screen, step by step.

Written for

Store Owners, Managers, Supervisors & Cashiers

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NOTE This is a non-technical guide. It assumes the POS Mobile app is already installed on the device. If it still needs installing or configuring, hand your IT person the *POS Mobile — Technical Manual* first.

1. About POS Mobile

POS Mobile (shown in the app as **Cartivo**) is a point-of-sale app that runs on an Android phone or tablet. It rings up sales, prints receipts to a Bluetooth or built-in thermal printer, tracks your cashiers' totals, and can receive online orders from your storefront.

What makes it different

- **Works offline.** Every sale, product, user and report is stored on the device itself. You can take orders and print receipts with no internet connection at all.
- **Internet is only needed for online orders.** The live *Orders* feed (orders placed through your website / kiosk) and one-time device registration need a connection. Nothing else does.
- **Backups happen automatically.** The app saves a full backup of its data to the phone's Downloads folder every few hours.

Who does what — the three roles

Role	Can do
Cashier	Take orders, take payment, print & void receipts (void needs a supervisor PIN), view transactions, run their own X-Reading and Daily Report, view online Orders, connect a printer.
Supervisor	Everything a cashier can do, <i>plus</i> Inventory, Users, Store Information, CSV import, Backup & Restore, and authorizing a Z-Reading.
Admin	Everything. The first account on a new device is an Admin.

NOTE Throughout this manual, steps marked **Admin** or **Supervisor** are hidden from cashiers.

2. Before you start

What you need

- An **Android phone or tablet** (Android 5.0 / API 21 or newer). A tablet gives a nicer two-column ordering screen but a phone works fully.
- The **POS Mobile app** installed. Your IT person builds and installs it — see the Technical Manual.
- A **thermal receipt printer** — either a Bluetooth printer, or a device with a built-in printer (some rugged Android POS terminals have one). Optional, but you can't print receipts without one.
- For online orders only: a **Wi-Fi or mobile data** connection and the store's registration details from your provider.

First launch

The very first time the app opens on a brand-new device it creates a single **Admin** account for you:

Field	Value
Name	Admin
Role	Admin
PIN	000000 (six zeros)

IMPORTANT You will be forced to change this PIN the first time you sign in. You cannot reach the app with the default PIN still active.

3. First-time setup (Admin)

Do these once, in order, on a new device. The app will actually prompt you for the first few automatically the first time an Admin reaches the dashboard.

- 1 Sign in and set your PIN.** On the account screen tap **Admin**, type `000000`, then choose a new 6-digit PIN and confirm it. (It can't be `000000`.)
- 2 Set the Store ID.** A pop-up asks for a unique Store ID and suggests one — accept it or type your own, then tap **Confirm**. This ID identifies your store to the online-orders service.
- 3 Fill in Store Information.** The Store Information form opens: enter Store Name (required), Address, TIN, and a Terminal Name (e.g. “Front Counter”). Tap **Save**.
- 4 Add payment methods.** On the same screen, in the Payment Methods card, add each method you accept (Cash, GCash, card, etc.). You need at least one before you can take payment.
- 5 Add your employees.** When prompted “No Employees Added” tap **Add Employee** (or open **Users** later). Create a card for each cashier and supervisor.
- 6 Import your products.** When prompted “No Products Found” tap **Import Products** and load a products CSV file (format below). You can also add products by hand in Inventory.
- 7 Connect a printer.** Go to **Settings** → **Printer Setup** and pair your Bluetooth receipt printer.
- 8 Register for online orders (optional).** Saving Store Information automatically registers this device with the online-orders service. It usually starts as “pending approval” until your provider approves it — see the *Orders* section.

NOTE You can skip the Employees and Products prompts and come back to them later — only the Store ID and Store Name are mandatory.

4. Signing in and PINs

Signing in

- 1 Open the app. You see a grid of account cards, one per active user.
- 2 Tap your card.
- 3 Type your **6-digit PIN** on the keypad. Sign-in happens automatically once the sixth digit is entered — there is no “enter” button.
- 4 A wrong PIN clears the field and shows an error; try again. Tap the back arrow to pick a different account.

NOTE There is no “remember me”. Every time the app is fully closed and reopened, everyone signs in again. Closing the app is the safest way to lock the till when you step away.

First-login PIN change

Any new account (and any account whose PIN an admin has reset) starts on the shared default PIN. On first sign-in the app makes that user choose a personal 6-digit PIN and confirm it before anything else.

Forgotten PIN

PINs can't be recovered, only reset. An Admin or Supervisor opens **Users**, taps the **:** menu on that person's card, chooses **Reset PIN**, and confirms. The user then signs in with the default PIN and sets a new one.

5. The Dashboard

The home screen after sign-in. It shows a greeting, the time, your name and role, a **Sign Out** button, a live-orders status pill, and a grid of tiles.

Tile	Opens	Who sees it
New Order	The ordering screen — take a sale	Everyone
Transactions	History of completed sales	Everyone
Inventory	Products, categories, modifiers	Admin / Supervisor
Cashier Accounting	X-Reading, Daily Report, Z-Reading	Everyone
Orders	Live online orders from your storefront (shows a red count badge when orders are waiting)	Everyone
Settings	Printer, store info, backups, CSV, export password	Everyone (some items Admin-only inside)
Users	Staff accounts	Admin / Supervisor

The live-orders status pill

Under the “Cartivo” logo a small pill shows the online-orders connection:

- **Live orders connected** — receiving online orders in real time.
- **Connecting... / Reconnecting...** — working on it.
- **Live orders off** — not connected (no internet, device not yet approved, or the feature isn't set up). Walk-in sales are unaffected.

6. New Order — taking a sale

Dashboard → **New Order**. On a tablet the product grid and the cart sit side by side; on a phone the cart is a bar at the bottom that opens as a sheet.

- 1 **Pick a category** from the chip row (or **All**), then **tap a product**.
- 2 In the product sheet, choose a **Variant** if the product has them (e.g. Small / Large — one is required), tick any **modifiers** (required groups are marked; optional groups show a max count), type **Notes** if needed (“no onions”), set the **quantity**, then tap **Add to Cart**.
- 3 Repeat for every item. The cart shows a running total.
- 4 Set the **order type** at the top of the cart: **Dine In** or **Take Out**.
- 5 Tap a cart line to expand it — change quantity, edit notes, or remove it. **Clear** empties the whole cart.
- 6 Apply discounts if needed (next section).
- 7 Tap **Proceed to Payment**.

NOTE A line item that has a discount on it is locked — its quantity can't be changed. Remove the discount (or the line) to edit it.

7. Discounts

There are two ways to discount, both reached from the cart:

Where	How
Per item	Expand a cart line — discounts are applied through the Apply Order Discount screen by selecting which items (and how many of each) the discount covers.
Whole order	Tap Apply Order Discount in the cart footer.

Discount types

- **Senior / PWD** — the statutory discount. Requires the cardholder's **ID number** and **name**. The covered items become VAT-exempt and the discount is calculated for you. Both fields are printed on the receipt as a **LESS:** line.
- **Promo** — requires a **promo code**.

- 1 On the **Apply Discount** screen, tick the items to discount. If an item has quantity > 1 you can choose how many units are covered.
- 2 Pick **Senior/PWD** or **Promo**.
- 3 Fill in the ID + name (Senior/PWD) or the code (Promo).
- 4 Check the summary (selected total, VAT exempt, discount amount).
- 5 Tap **Apply Discount**.

NOTE Items that are already discounted show a lock icon and can't be selected again.

8. Payment

The payment screen shows the order summary with a full VAT breakdown (VATable sales, VAT-exempt sales, VAT, discount) and the total due.

- 1 Tap a **payment method**. The methods shown are the ones set up in Store Information.
- 2 For **Cash**: enter the amount the customer handed over. The sheet shows the **change** due. Confirm.
- 3 For **GCash / card / any other method**: enter a **reference number** and confirm.
- 4 The selected method shows a tick and a caption (cash tendered + change, or the reference).
- 5 Tap **Confirm Payment · PHP ...** at the bottom.
- 6 The receipt screen opens. The sale is now recorded.

NOTE Only one payment method per sale. To change it, tap the method again before confirming.

IMPORTANT "No payment methods configured" means an Admin still needs to add one in **SETTINGS → STORE INFORMATION → PAYMENT METHODS**.

9. Receipts

Reading the receipt

The on-screen receipt mirrors what prints: store name / address / TIN, "Sales Invoice", date and **SI#** (invoice number), cashier, the item lines, the VAT summary, payment details, and "Thank You!". A green banner confirms **Payment Successful**; a voided sale shows a red **VOIDED** stamp.

Printing

- **Print (Built-in)** — appears if the device has an internal printer.
- **Print (Bluetooth)** — appears if a Bluetooth printer is saved.
- If neither is set up, a note points you to **Settings** → **Printer Setup**.

After a sale

- **New Order** (top right) — start the next sale.
- Back arrow — returns to the dashboard.

Void Transaction

VOIDS a completed sale (there is no partial refund in this app — a void cancels the whole transaction).

- 1 On the receipt tap **Void Transaction**.
- 2 Type a **reason** (required).
- 3 Pick a **supervisor or admin** as the authorizer and have them enter their **PIN**.
- 4 Tap **Void Transaction**. The receipt now shows the VOIDED stamp and the reason.

IMPORTANT A sale can no longer be voided once it has been included in a closed X-Reading, Daily Report, or Z-Reading. The receipt says so and hides the button.

10. Transactions

Dashboard → **Transactions**. Every completed sale, newest first.

- **Search** by invoice number (e.g. #000123).
- **Filter by date** with the calendar icon.
- Scroll to load more; pull down to refresh.
- Tap a row to open its **receipt** (where you can reprint or void).
- Voided sales are marked and can't be voided again.

11. Orders — online / storefront orders

Dashboard → **Orders**. This is a live feed of orders placed somewhere else — your website, a kiosk, a delivery channel — and pushed to this device. It is separate from the walk-in sales you ring up in New Order.

Getting notified

- When the app is open, a coloured toast appears for every new, updated, or cancelled order, on whatever screen you're on.
- A device notification also fires, so you see new orders even when the app is in the background.
- The Orders tile on the dashboard shows a red count of orders still needing attention.

Working an order

- 1 Open **Orders**. Tabs across the top filter by status; each shows a count.
- 2 Tap an order card to see its full detail (customer, items, fulfilment type — on-site / pickup / delivery).
- 3 Move the order along with the status control: **Pending** → **Preparing** → **Ready** → **Fulfilled**.
- 4 **Cancel** an order that can't be fulfilled (not available once it's already fulfilled).
- 5 Pull down to refresh the list.

IMPORTANT If Orders shows “Can't load orders” with a message about the store ID or configuration, the device's registration was rejected — check **SETTINGS** → **STORE INFORMATION** and the registration status card there.

12. Cashier Accounting

Dashboard → **Cashier Accounting**. Three reports, each with a live view, a **Close & Print** action, and a **History** of past closed copies you can reprint.

Report	Scope	Closing
X-Reading	A running snapshot of <i>your own</i> sales since your last X-Reading — payment breakdown, transaction / void / refund counts, discounts, VAT, cash collected, average / highest / lowest sale.	Close & Print ends the current period and starts a fresh one. A simple confirm.
Daily Report (Cashier Report)	<i>Your own</i> VAT and cash summary for the day — gross sales, VATable / VAT / VAT-exempt, net of tax, sales by product, and a cash ledger.	Close & Print , simple confirm.
Z-Reading	The <i>store-wide</i> end-of-day close — all cashiers, beginning and ending balance, grand totals, sales by cashier, a Z-counter that increments each close.	Close & Print requires a supervisor / admin PIN to authorize.

To close a reading

- 1 Open the reading. Review the on-screen figures.
- 2 Tap **Close & Print ...** (disabled if there were no transactions in the period).
- 3 Confirm (Z-Reading: also pick an authorizer and enter their PIN).
- 4 The reading is saved to History and sent to the printer. If printing fails you still keep the closed record — reprint it from History.

IMPORTANT Closing is permanent and can't be undone. It also “locks” every transaction in that period against voiding.

Exporting transactions

The **download** icon on the Cashier Accounting screen exports a CSV of all transactions for a date range you pick:

- **Download file** — saves to Downloads/ on the device.
- **Email** — sends the CSV to one or more recipients you enter (remembered for next time).

NOTE If a CSV Export Password has been set, you're asked for it before any export.

13. Inventory

Admin / Supervisor

Dashboard → **Inventory**. Three tabs: **Products**, **Categories**, **Modifiers**.

Products tab

- Search, filter by category chip, pull to refresh.
- **Add Product** (the + button) or tap a product to edit it.

The product form

- **Photo** — optional; pick from the device.
- **Name** and **Category** — both required.
- **Variants** — at least one is required. Each has a name and a price (min 0.01). Exactly one active variant is the **default**. Add as many as you need (Small / Medium / Large, etc.).
- **Modifier groups** — tick which modifier groups this product offers (e.g. "Add-ons", "Sugar level").

NOTE Removing a variant that has never been sold deletes it; one that has sales is deactivated instead so past receipts and reports stay correct.

Categories tab

Create, rename, reorder and deactivate the categories that group your products and drive the category chips on the ordering screen.

Modifiers tab

Manage **modifier groups** and their **options**:

- A group has a **name**, a **Required** flag, and a **max selections** count (1 = choose one; more = multi-select).
- Each option has a **name** and an optional **added price** (e.g. "Extra cheese +20.00").
- Attach groups to products from the product form (above).

Importing products from CSV

Settings → **Import CSV** → **Products**. Expected columns (same format as the kiosk app):

```
Category, Category Description, Product Name, Product Description,  
Product Base Price, Variant Name, Variant Price, [Product Image URL]
```


Import mode	Effect
Add & Update	Adds new products, updates existing ones by name. Nothing already in your menu is removed. (Default — safe.)
Replace Entire Menu	The file becomes your whole menu. Categories / products / variants not in the file are deleted (items with past sales are kept but disabled). Asks you to confirm first.

14. Users

Admin / Supervisor

Dashboard → **Users**. One card per staff member; a green / grey dot shows active / inactive.

Add a user

- 1 Tap **Add User**.
- 2 Optionally choose a **photo**.
- 3 Enter **Full Name** (required), and optionally Employee ID and Phone.
- 4 Pick a **Role**: Cashier, Supervisor, or Admin.
- 5 Tap **Add User**. They start on the default PIN and set their own on first sign-in.

Manage a user

The **:** menu on each card:

- **Edit** — change name, role, photo, contact details, or the **Active** switch. An inactive user can't sign in and doesn't appear on the account grid.
- **Reset PIN** — back to the default; they set a new one next sign-in.
- **Delete** — permanent, can't be undone.

NOTE Keep at least one working Admin account. If you lock yourself out, the only recovery is restoring a backup or a fresh install (which recreates the default Admin).

15. Settings

Setting	What it does	Who
Import CSV	Bulk-load Products, Modifiers, Users, or Store Info from CSV files.	Admin
Backup & Restore	Make a backup now, or replace all device data from a backup file.	Admin
CSV Export Password	Shows whether a password is required to download report CSVs. The password itself is set by IT in the app's configuration, not here.	Admin
Store Information	Store ID, name, address, TIN, terminal name, payment methods, and the online-orders device registration status.	Admin
Printer Setup	Find and connect a Bluetooth printer; test print / calibrate.	Everyone

Store Information fields

Field	Notes
Store ID	Unique code identifying the store to the online-orders service. Set once at first launch.
Store Name	Required. Prints at the top of every receipt.
Address	Prints on the receipt.
TIN	Tax identification number; prints on the receipt.
Terminal Name	A label for this device, e.g. "Front Counter".
Payment Methods	Add / edit / remove. Cash, GCash, and card have preset labels; "Other" lets you name your own. Non-cash methods can carry an account number.

16. Backups

The app protects your data automatically. You rarely need to touch this — but know how it works.

Automatic backups

- A full backup (all data + product images, as a `.zip`) is written to **Downloads** → **POS Backups** roughly every **3 hours**.
- If nothing changed since the last one, it's skipped (no duplicate files).
- When the app is opened after being closed for a while, it runs a catch-up backup if the last one is more than 3 hours old.
- Backups older than **7 days** are deleted automatically.

Back Up Now

Settings → **Backup & Restore** → **Back Up Now** forces a fresh backup immediately. Do this before a big change (a menu replace, handing the device to someone else) or before you update the app.

Restore Data

IMPORTANT Restoring **REPLACES EVERYTHING** currently on the device with the contents of the backup file — all sales, products, users and settings. There is no merge.

- 1 **Settings** → **Backup & Restore** → **Restore Data**.
- 2 **Choose backup file** and pick a `.zip` from Downloads / POS Backups (or wherever you copied one).
- 3 Tap **Restore**, then confirm **Yes, Restore**.
- 4 A safety backup of the *current* data is made first, then the restore runs. "Restore Complete" confirms it.

Moving to a new device

1. On the old device: **Back Up Now**.
2. Copy the newest `pos_backup_....zip` from Downloads / POS Backups to the new device (cable, cloud drive, email to yourself).
3. On the new device: install the app, sign in as the default Admin, then **Restore Data** from that file.

17. Printer setup

Settings → **Printer Setup**. Receipts print to an 80mm (or 58mm) ESC/POS thermal printer over Bluetooth, or to a built-in printer if the device has one.

Connect a Bluetooth printer

- 1 Turn the printer on and make sure the phone's Bluetooth is on.
- 2 Tap **Scan for Printers**. Grant the Bluetooth permission if asked. On some Android versions you may also be prompted to turn on Location or Bluetooth — the screen shows a button for each.
- 3 Under **Paired devices** tap yours to connect, or under **Available devices** tap to pair then connect.
- 4 “Connected to ...” confirms it. The printer now shows under **Current Printer** with a green tick.

Remove disconnects and forgets the saved printer.

Calibration (only if receipts look wrong)

- **Print Calibration Ruler** — prints a numbered ruler. Note the last full number before the paper edge / wrap.
- **Print Width Probe** — prints lines `w=50 ... 59`. Find the highest `w` whose `|` is still on the end of its line.
- Give those numbers to your IT / supplier so the receipt width can be corrected.

18. Daily routine

Opening

- Sign in.
- Check the printer is on and connected (Settings → Printer Setup, or just print any receipt).
- If you use online orders, check the dashboard pill says **Live orders connected**.

During the shift

- Take sales through **New Order**.
- Watch **Orders** for online orders and move them along the status steps.
- Void mistakes from the receipt (needs a supervisor PIN).

Closing

- Each cashier: **Cashier Accounting** → **X-Reading** → **Close & Print**, and **Daily Report** → **Close & Print**.
- Supervisor / Admin: **Z-Reading** → **Close & Print** (authorize with your PIN) for the store-wide close.
- Optionally export the day's transactions (download or email).
- **Sign Out**, or fully close the app.

19. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Problem	What to do
Can't sign in — “wrong PIN”	Make sure the right account card is selected. An Admin / Supervisor can Reset PIN from Users.
Stuck on the “Set Your PIN” screen	That account is on the default PIN. Choose a new 6-digit PIN (not 000000) and confirm it — there's no way past it otherwise.
No products on the ordering screen	Import a products CSV (Settings → Import CSV) or add products in Inventory. Also check the product / its variant is marked available.
“No payment methods configured”	Admin: Settings → Store Information → Payment Methods → add at least one.
Receipt won't print	Settings → Printer Setup: is a printer under “Current Printer”? Is it powered on and in range? Re-scan and reconnect. Try the calibration print.
Printer not found when scanning	Turn Bluetooth off and on. Grant the Bluetooth permission (Open App Settings if it was permanently denied). On older Android, turn on Location Services.
Void button missing on a receipt	The sale is already part of a closed X-Reading, Daily Report or Z-Reading and can no longer be voided.
“Live orders off” / Orders won't load	Check internet. Check the device-registration status in Settings → Store Information (it may be pending approval or rejected). Walk-in sales still work regardless.
Can't open Inventory / Users / some Settings	Those are Admin / Supervisor only. Ask an admin, or sign in with an admin account.
Wrong totals in a reading	Tap the refresh icon on that reading. X-Reading and Daily Report are per-cashier — make sure you're signed in as the right person.

Frequently asked

Does it need internet?

No, except for the online **Orders** feed and one-time device registration. All selling, printing and reporting works offline.

Where are my backups?

On the device: **Downloads** → **POS Backups**, named `pos_backup_<date>.zip`. New one every ~3 hours, kept for 7 days.

Can two people be signed in at once?

No — one user at a time per device. Sign out (or close the app) to switch. Voids and Z-Readings let a supervisor authorize with their PIN without signing the cashier out.

Can I refund part of a sale?

This version supports a full **Void** of a transaction, not a partial line refund.

